

Strategic Convergence and the Defense of the Undersea Commons: A Geopolitical Analysis of British Isles Digital Security in the Era of Hybrid Confrontation

The structural integrity of the global internet in 2026 is no longer a matter of mere commercial interest; it has become the primary theater of geopolitical competition between the Western alliance and the revisionist powers of the Russian Federation and its proxies. As the modern world increasingly relies on the "anthropogenic shell"—the fragile infrastructure of cables, pipelines, and data centers—the British Isles have emerged as both a critical global gateway and a uniquely vulnerable target for hybrid warfare. This report provides an exhaustive analysis of the shared internet infrastructure linking the British Isles, the Commonwealth, and the United States, while contrasting these networks against the adversarial doctrines of the Russian Federation. Furthermore, it delineates the deployment of "whitehat" technologies—defined as defensive, resilient, and proactive security measures—to neutralize "blackhat" offensive operations and leverages the United Kingdom's unique geographical position to establish a "digital fortress" strategy.

The Global Backbone: Undersea Infrastructure and Strategic Chokepoints

The global internet is underpinned by approximately 1.2 million kilometers of submarine fiber-optic cables that carry 99% of intercontinental telecommunications traffic.¹ These cables are the unseen arteries of the global economy, facilitating over \$10 trillion in daily financial transactions and hosting the mission-critical communications of governments and militaries.³ For the British Isles, this reliance is existential. As an island nation, the UK's digital economy is entirely dependent on its 64 active subsea cables, which connect it to the European continent, the United States, and the wider Commonwealth.¹

The UK-US Transatlantic Nexus

The transatlantic corridor remains the most valuable and heavily trafficked subsea route in the world. The connection between the British Isles and North America is characterized by extreme concentration. While the UK hosts dozens of cables, approximately 75% of all transatlantic internet traffic is carried by just two high-capacity cable systems that make landfall at Bude in Cornwall.¹ This concentration creates a systemic bottleneck; a coordinated

attack on these specific landing points could freeze global banking systems, disrupt energy logistics, and spark widespread social panic without a single kinetic shot being fired.¹ The 2023 Atlantic Declaration has served as a pivotal framework for strengthening this nexus. By deepening collaboration in artificial intelligence (AI) research and streamlining free data flows, the UK and US have begun to treat their shared digital infrastructure as a unified security domain.⁷ This partnership is not merely economic; it involves the integration of the Integrated Undersea Surveillance System (IUSS), a joint US-UK military network designed to track adversarial submarine movements in the North Atlantic.⁴

Commonwealth Connectivity and Indo-Pacific Vulnerabilities

The Commonwealth network represents a diverse and expansive digital ecosystem, yet it faces varying degrees of resilience. In the Anglophone sphere, nations like Australia, Canada, and India are investing heavily in dual-path architectures and redundant routes to mitigate the risk of isolation.¹⁰ However, the "soft underbelly" of the Western alliance is found in the Francophone and Anglophone peripheries, such as the Sahel and the overseas territories in the Indian and Pacific Oceans.¹² For instance, Reunion Island and Mayotte serve as critical digital hubs for French and allied naval power in the Indian Ocean, hosting landing stations for the SAFE and METISS cables.¹² Similarly, the Gondwana-1 cable provides the sole high-speed link for New Caledonia. These locations are increasingly being probed by Russian research vessels under the guise of the "Great African Expedition," which maps bathymetric vulnerabilities that could be exploited to impose an "information blockade" on isolated territories.¹²

Region	Cable System Concentration	Primary Strategic Role	Key Landing Stations
Transatlantic (UK-US)	High (Apollo, Atlantic Crossing-1)	Global Financial Backbone	Bude (Cornwall), Shirley (NY) ¹
Western Europe (UK-EU)	Very High (C-Lion1, TAT-14)	Regional Continuity	Lowestoft, Calais, Zeebrugge ¹³
Indian Ocean (Reunion/SA)	Moderate (SAFE, 2Africa)	Indo-Pacific Security	Saint-Paul, Mtunzini ¹²
Pacific (Australia-US)	Moderate (Southern Cross)	Commonwealth Resilience	Sydney, Hawa'ii ¹⁵

Adversarial Doctrine: The Russian "Hybrid Trident"

The Russian Federation has operationalized a sophisticated, multi-layered threat model known as the "Hybrid Trident".¹² This doctrine integrates three distinct but synchronized domains of warfare: maritime sabotage (Physical), cyber offensive operations (Logical), and cognitive manipulation (Psychological). By 2026, these operations have moved beyond isolated incidents to become a continuous state of "information confrontation" (IPb) designed to erode the Western alliance's will to resist.¹²

Physical Domain: Maritime Sabotage and GUGI

The Main Directorate for Deep Sea Research (GUGI) represents the pinnacle of Russia's undersea warfare capabilities. Operating independently of the regular Russian Navy, GUGI manages a fleet of specialized submarines, such as the *Belgorod* and *Losharik*, alongside oceanographic research vessels like the *Yantar*.¹² The *Yantar* (Project 22010) is officially a research ship but is equipped with deep-sea submersibles (Rus and Consul) capable of reaching depths of 6,000 meters to map, tap, or sever undersea cables.³

Throughout late 2024 and 2025, the *Yantar* conducted highly provocative maneuvers in the Irish Sea and North Sea—critical chokepoints for the UK's transatlantic lifelines.¹² During these incursions, the vessel was shadowed by the HMS *Somerset* and RAF P-8 Poseidon aircraft. In a significant escalation, the *Yantar* directed laser dazzlers at British pilots, a "grey zone" tactic intended to intimidate personnel and disrupt sensor monitoring.¹² These "shaping operations" are prerequisites for sabotage, allowing GUGI to identify precise locations where cable cuts would be most difficult to repair, particularly in deep-water underwater canyons.⁹

Logical Domain: Cyber-Kinetic Integration

In the logical domain, the GRU's Unit 29155—historically known for assassinations—has fully integrated offensive cyber capabilities to target the Operational Technology (OT) and Industrial Control Systems (ICS) that run through subsea networks.¹² Unlike traditional espionage, which seeks to remain undetected, Unit 29155's missions are often destructive. They utilize malware like "WhisperGate" to irrevocably destroy data, aiming to induce systemic collapse in logistics and transport networks.¹²

Russia further supplements its state capabilities by coordinating with proxy "hacktivist" groups such as the Cyber Army of Russia Reborn (CARR). These groups target Human-Machine Interfaces (HMIs) in US and European water and energy utilities.¹² While these attacks may lack the sophistication of the GRU, they create a high volume of "digital noise," forcing Western defenders to expend vast resources on remediation while simultaneously eroding public trust in the reliability of basic services.¹²

Cognitive Domain: Automated Disinformation

The third prong of the Trident is cognitive warfare. Russian operations have evolved from manual "troll farms" to industrialized, AI-driven networks like "Portal Kombat" and the "African Initiative".¹² The Portal Kombat network, exposed by the French agency VIGINUM, utilizes at least 193 automated news portals to disseminate pro-Russian narratives across Europe and the UK.¹²

These campaigns are psychographically targeted, leveraging "Big Five" personality traits to craft messages that exploit societal anxieties. In the British Isles, these narratives often focus on domestic fissures such as the cost of living or immigration, while in the Commonwealth, they pivot to "traditional values vs. Western decadence" to undermine the moral authority of the UK and its allies.¹⁰ This "information flood" aims to destroy the concept of a shared reality,

making it impossible for democratic societies to reach a consensus on security threats.¹²

Whitehat Technology: Defending the Undersea Frontier

To counter these "blackhat" threats, the United Kingdom and its allies have pioneered a suite of whitehat technologies—defensive innovations designed to enhance the resilience, monitoring, and proactive defense of undersea infrastructure.

Project CABOT and the "Hybrid Navy"

The UK’s Strategic Defence Review of 2025 emphasizes the transformation of the Royal Navy into a "hybrid navy".²⁶ The centerpiece of this effort is **Project CABOT**, a seven-year, £400 million program designed to create a persistent anti-submarine warfare (ASW) barrier in the North Atlantic, particularly around the GIUK gap.²⁹

Project CABOT is implemented in two distinct phases:

- 1. **Phase 1: Atlantic Net (2025-2027):** This phase utilizes a Contractor Owned, Contractor Operated, Naval Oversight (COCONO) model.²⁹ It deploys a fleet of autonomous surface vessels and underwater gliders, such as the SG-1 Fathom and the Rattler, to gather acoustic data.³² This data is triaged using AI/ML algorithms to identify adversarial signatures before being transmitted to a secure Remote Operations Centre (ROC) for final human analysis.³⁴
- 2. **Phase 2: Bastion Atlantic (2028 and beyond):** This phase transitions to a Government Owned, Government Operated (GOGO) model, introducing dedicated platforms like the Type 92 Sloop (an uncrewed surface vessel) and the Type 93 Chariot (an uncrewed underwater vehicle).³¹ It also considers the use of Underwater Battlespace Area Denial (UBAD) capabilities, signaling a renewed interest in maritime mines to protect sensitive infrastructure zones.³¹

Fiber-Optic Sensing: "Listening with Light"

A transformative whitehat innovation is the development of Distributed Fiber Optic Sensing (DFOS). Technologies such as **OptiBarrier**, developed by Dutch scaleup Optics11, and AP Sensing’s acoustic monitoring systems, allow subsea cables to function as massive sonar arrays.³⁷

By injecting light pulses into unused or "dark" fibers within an existing cable, these systems can detect minute pressure changes and vibrations caused by approaching ships, submersibles, or even divers.³⁷ Unlike traditional sonar, which emits detectable pulses, DFOS is entirely passive and "unjammable".³⁷ This allows coastal authorities to identify the exact make and model of an approaching vessel from its sound pattern alone, providing the early warning necessary for physical interdiction.³⁷

Whitehat Technology	Functionality	Strategic Advantage	Operational
---------------------	---------------	---------------------	-------------

			Deployment
SG-1 Fathom	Autonomous Underwater Glider	Low-cost, persistent seafloor ISR	Deployed in Atlantic Net ³²
OptiBarrier	Fiber-optic "listening" sensors	Passive, unjammable detection	Tested at SeaSEC, The Hague ³⁷
Type 92 Sloop	Uncrewed Surface Vessel (USV)	Towed-array sonar mass	Planned for Bastion Atlantic ³⁵
GovAssure	Cyber security assessment	Objective government-critical auditing	Rollout across UK depts ⁴⁰

Leveraging Geography: The British Isles as a "Digital Fortress"

The United Kingdom possesses a unique geographical and strategic advantage that can be leveraged to put the security of the British Isles first. By combining its position as a transatlantic gateway with a "Digital Fortress" strategy, the UK can ensure its operational freedom even in a contested environment.

The Gateway Advantage and Data Sovereign Clusters

The UK is exceptionally well-connected, hosting one of the world's most important internet exchange points—the London Internet Exchange (LINX).⁷ Beyond the capital, emerging digital hubs in Manchester, Birmingham, and the Glasgow-Edinburgh corridor offer opportunities for decentralized digital infrastructure.⁷ These regions can leverage substantial renewable energy capabilities (particularly North Sea wind) for cooling and powering massive data center clusters.⁷

The designating of data centers as "Nationally Significant Infrastructure Projects" in 2025 allows the UK to enforce tighter security and resilience requirements on these facilities.⁴² By building 6GW of AI-ready compute capacity on UK soil by 2030, the UK aims to reduce its reliance on foreign-trained models and ensure that sensitive datasets—such as healthcare (genomic) archives and national security records—remain under UK jurisdiction.⁴³

The "Fortress Approach" to Sovereign Cloud

To mitigate the risk of foreign interference and legal exposure (such as the US CLOUD Act), the UK is shifting toward a "Sovereign Cloud" model.⁴⁴ This framework ensures that:

1. **Jurisdictional Control:** Data is hosted, processed, and supported entirely within UK borders by UK-cleared personnel, subject exclusively to English law.⁴⁴
2. **Cross-Domain Solutions (CDS):** Secure policy-controlled gateways manage the exchange of data between different security classification levels, preventing unauthorized lateral movement.⁴⁴
3. **Post-Quantum Cryptography (PQC):** With the window for preparing legacy systems

closing, the UK is prioritizing the transition to quantum-resilient encryption to protect long-term sensitive data from "harvest now, decrypt later" attacks.⁴⁶

Comparative Analysis: Resilience vs. Fragility

The current geopolitical climate demands a shift from a "efficiency-first" model to a "resilience-first" model. While the UK subsea network enjoys a good level of resilience in "business-as-usual" scenarios, the possibility of coordinated state-backed sabotage reveals significant gaps in current contingency planning.

Feature	Commercial Model (2010s)	Security-First Model (2026)	Strategic Implication
Repair Capability	Commercial Consortia (ACMA)	Sovereign Repair Ships (Proposed)	Reduces dependence on foreign vessels during crisis ⁶
Monitoring	Reactive (wait for break)	Persistent (AI/Autonomous ISR)	Enables "tripwire" deterrence and rapid attribution ²⁷
Infrastructure	Concentrated at Bude/London	Decentralized Sovereign Clusters	Mitigates systemic collapse from single-point strikes ¹
Cloud Hosting	Global/Public Cloud	UK Sovereign Cloud	Ensures data protection from foreign legal claims ⁴⁵

One of the most pressing concerns identified by the Joint Committee on the National Security Strategy is the lack of genuinely sovereign repair capabilities.⁶ Currently, the UK relies on commercial consortia whose ships may not be available or willing to enter a conflict zone. To address this, the government is exploring the acquisition of a sovereign repair vessel, a move that would provide the UK with the autonomous ability to restore its digital lifelines in a time-sensitive security crisis.⁶

Whitehat Offensive: The National Cyber Force and Deterrence

The defense of the British Isles also requires an offensive dimension. The UK’s National Cyber Force (NCF) and the newly stood-up Defence Cyber & Electromagnetic Force (DCEMF) are tasked with conducting cyber operations to "counter those who would do the UK harm".⁴⁹ These whitehat offensive tactics include:

- **Disrupting C2 Infrastructure:** Neutralizing the command-and-control servers used by Russian hackers and GUGI submersibles.⁴⁹
- **Narrative Counter-Exploitation:** Using the "naming and shaming" strategy (as seen with France's exposure of Portal Kombat) to publicly attribute hybrid attacks and erode

the effectiveness of adversarial disinformation.¹²

- **Honeypot Infrastructure:** Deploying decoy sensors and "dumb" cables that mimic critical assets, tricking adversarial mapping vessels into exposing their own capabilities and locations.⁵⁰

Conclusion: Strategic Recommendations for a Resilient Future

The analysis of 2026 internet infrastructure reveals that the British Isles stand at the center of a "shadow war" that operates just below the threshold of open conflict. To preserve its national security and economic prosperity, the UK must move beyond rhetorical recognition of the threat and adopt a proactive, multi-domain defense strategy.

The successful implementation of Project CABOT and the transition to a hybrid navy are essential steps in creating a "layered network of tripwires and firepower" in the North Atlantic.²⁷ However, physical security must be matched by cognitive and logical resilience. The UK must continue to lead the Commonwealth in establishing standards for undersea cable resilience, as demonstrated by its hosting of the Porto Summit.⁵¹

Finally, the UK should prioritize the development of sovereign data paths and "geopatriated" cloud services to ensure that the data driving its economy remains protected under its own laws.⁴⁵ By leveraging its geography as a gateway to both the Americas and Europe, and by deploying cutting-edge whitehat technologies to monitor and defend its undersea arteries, the British Isles can turn its historic geostrategy of "splendid isolation" into a modern strategy of "digital fortress" leadership, putting the security of the homeland first in an increasingly contested world.

Works cited

1. Russia Threatens UK Undersea Infrastructure and Fiber-Optic Cables, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://www.bcsatellite.net/blog/russia-threatens-uk-undersea-infrastructure-and-fiber-optic-cables/>
2. Strategic Anti-Access/Area denial in cyberspace - NATO Cooperative Cyber Defence Centre of Excellence, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://ccdcoe.org/uploads/2018/10/Art-11-Strategic-Anti-Access-Area-Denial-in-Cyberspace.pdf>
3. russia is preparing attacks on submarine cables in Europe | Центр протидії дезінформації, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://cpd.gov.ua/en/international-threats-en/europe/russia-is-preparing-attacks-on-submarine-cables-in-europe/>
4. FT: Russian ship monitored critical European cables for months, likely preparing for sabotage | Ukrainska Pravda, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://www.pravda.com.ua/eng/news/2025/09/26/7532686/>
5. Subsea telecommunications cables: resilience and crisis preparedness -

- Parliament UK, accessed January 28, 2026,
<https://publications.parliament.uk/pa/jt5901/jtselect/jtnatsec/723/report.html>
6. Subsea Telecommunications Cables: Resilience and Crisis Preparedness - Hansard, accessed January 28, 2026,
<https://hansard.parliament.uk/commons/2026-01-08/debates/3638F695-5933-4976-93A8-0AAC5C994B72/SubseaTelecommunicationsCablesResilienceAndCrisisPreparedness>
 7. Can the UK leverage its advantages to lead the data centre race ..., accessed January 28, 2026,
<https://www.majentasolutions.com/news/can-the-uk-leverage-its-advantages-to-lead-the-data-centre-race>
 8. Atlantic Declaration Deepens U.S.-UK Space Cooperation, accessed January 28, 2026,
<https://space.commerce.gov/atlantic-declaration-deepens-u-s-uk-space-cooperation/>
 9. 'Moscow military spy ship' seen mapping and surveilling NATO undersea cables — 'She's following cable lines and pipelines, making stops. We are monitoring her very closely | Tom's Hardware, accessed January 28, 2026,
<https://www.tomshardware.com/tech-industry/moscow-military-spy-ship-tracked-mapping-and-surveilling-nato-undersea-cables-shes-following-cable-lines-and-pipelines-making-stops-we-are-monitoring-her-very-closely>
 10. Policy Brief: Enhancing the Resilience of Submarine Internet Infrastructure, accessed January 28, 2026,
<https://www.internetsociety.org/resources/policybriefs/2025/enhancing-the-resilience-of-submarine-internet-infrastructure/>
 11. Securing Subsea Infrastructure - Submarine Cables EMEA 2026, accessed January 28, 2026,
<https://www.europe.submarine-cables-summit.com/trend/cable-security>
 12. Russia, US Cyber Influence Comparison.pdf
 13. Digital Lifelines: Undersea Cables, Chokepoints, And The Evolving Sea Lines Of Communication – Analysis - Eurasia Review, accessed January 28, 2026,
<https://www.eurasiareview.com/26122025-digital-lifelines-undersea-cables-chokepoints-and-the-evolving-sea-lines-of-communication-analysis/>
 14. UK strengthens subsea cables against Russian interference - TechRadar, accessed January 28, 2026,
<https://www.techradar.com/pro/security/uk-strengthens-subsea-cables-against-russian-interference>
 15. Submarine communications cable - Wikipedia, accessed January 28, 2026,
https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Submarine_communications_cable
 16. Submarine Cable Map, accessed January 28, 2026,
<https://www.submarinecablemap.com/>
 17. A Theoretical 2026 Model of Russia's Cyber War Against Europe - Medium, accessed January 28, 2026,
https://medium.com/@madjid.tehrani_17692/a-theoretical-2026-model-of-russias-cyber-war-against-europe-a348848cafe8

18. Russian Maritime Sabotage: From Subcomponent of Special Operations to Evolving Form of Irregular Warfare, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://irregularwarfare.org/articles/russian-maritime-sabotage-from-subcomponent-of-special-operations-to-evolving-form-of-irregular-warfare/>
19. Russian Ship “Yantar” - Hansard - UK Parliament, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://hansard.parliament.uk/Lords/2025-11-25/debates/4005241F-D0B1-42F6-9592-2993D5DB7B3C/RussianShip%E2%80%9CYantar%E2%80%9D>
20. Russian Spy Vessel Yantar Caught Mapping UK Undersea Cables, Directs Lasers at British RAF Pilots - YouTube, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZdJVGoW2I7s>
21. 2034 and the Threat of Russian Submarine Cable Sabotage By: Lane Burdette, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://bush.tamu.edu/wp-content/uploads/2021/05/Burdette-CGS-FINAL.pdf>
22. From space to seabed - Policy Exchange, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://policyexchange.org.uk/publication/from-space-to-seabed/>
23. Government strengthens undersea cables coordination following Committee report, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://committees.parliament.uk/committee/111/national-security-strategy-joint-committee/news/211009/government-strengthens-undersea-cables-coordination-following-committee-report/>
24. Trump 'wrong' | 'Landmark pact' on North Sea wind | Kerry on Greenland - Carbon Brief, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://www.carbonbrief.org/daily-brief/trump-wrong-landmark-pact-on-north-sea-wind-kerry-on-greenland/>
25. Russian hybrid warfare has become indistinguishable from politics - Defense One, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://www.defenseone.com/threats/2026/01/russian-hybrid-warfare-has-become-indistinguishable-politics/410867/>
26. UK unveils new undersea warfare technology to counter threat from ..., accessed January 28, 2026, <https://www.gov.uk/government/news/uk-unveils-new-undersea-warfare-technology-to-counter-threat-from-russia>
27. UK Royal Navy Details Multi-layered, All-Domain Approach to ..., accessed January 28, 2026, <https://www.navalnews.com/naval-news/2025/12/uk-royal-navy-details-multi-layered-all-domain-approach-to-building-north-atlantic-deterrence/>
28. shownews - UK: a chaotic release for a vague Review - FW-MAG Future Warfare Magazine, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://www.fw-mag.com/shownews/566/uk-a-chaotic-release-for-a-vague-review>
29. Atlantic Bastion: The Future of Anti-Submarine Warfare - Foreign Policy Research Institute, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://www.fpri.org/article/2025/08/atlantic-bastion-the-future-of-anti-submarine-warfare/>
30. shownews - Project CABOT: a Royal Navy ASW barrier for the North Atlantic -

- FW-MAG Future Warfare Magazine, accessed January 28, 2026,
<https://www.fw-mag.com/shownews/397/project-cabot-a-royal-navy-asw-barrier-for-the-north-atlantic>
31. PROJECT CABOT - SECURING THE NORTH ATLANTIC - Society of ..., accessed January 28, 2026,
https://www.maritimeindustries.org/application/files/4017/3989/4161/20250212-CABOT_Navy_Tech_Slide_DB-O_5.pdf
 32. Project CABOT, transforming ASW for the Royal Navy - Calibre Defence, accessed January 28, 2026,
<https://www.calibredefence.co.uk/project-cabot-transforming-asw-for-the-royal-navy/>
 33. UK unveils undersea military technology to defend against Russian threats - Sky News, accessed January 28, 2026,
<https://news.sky.com/story/uk-unveils-undersea-military-technology-to-defend-against-russian-threats-13480789>
 34. Atlantic Bastion, Lunna House, and opportunities for industry in the High North, accessed January 28, 2026,
<https://www.naval-technology.com/analyst-comment/atlantic-bastion-lunna-house-high-north/>
 35. Project Cabot : The Future of Undersea Dominance » DefenceXP - Indian Defence Network, accessed January 28, 2026,
<https://www.defencexp.com/project-cabot-the-future-of-undersea-dominance/>
 36. Project CABOT: a Royal Navy ASW barrier for the North Atlantic : r/unitedkingdom - Reddit, accessed January 28, 2026,
https://www.reddit.com/r/unitedkingdom/comments/1irldcc/project_cabot_a_royal_navy_asw_barrier_for_the/
 37. New sensors listen with light to prevent European submarine cable ..., accessed January 28, 2026,
<https://www.fanaticalfuturist.com/2025/10/new-sensors-listen-with-light-to-prevent-european-submarine-cable-sabotage/>
 38. New undersea cable tech listens for sabotage — can be retrofitted to existing fiber optic lines, accessed January 28, 2026,
<https://www.tomshardware.com/tech-industry/new-undersea-cable-tech-listens-for-sabotage-can-be-retrofitted-to-existing-fiber-optic-lines>
 39. Subsea internet cables can now 'listen' for sabotage using irregular pulses of light, accessed January 28, 2026,
<https://www.techradar.com/pro/security/subsea-internet-cables-can-now-listen-for-sabotage-using-irregular-pulses-of-light>
 40. The Government Cyber Action Plan: strengthening resilience across ..., accessed January 28, 2026,
<https://www.ncsc.gov.uk/blog-post/government-cyber-action-plan-strengthening-resilience-across-uk>
 41. North Sea Nations Will Vow to Jointly Build and Protect Wind Sites - Insurance Journal, accessed January 28, 2026,
<https://www.insurancejournal.com/news/international/2026/01/26/855526.htm>

42. Europe's Playbook, Britain's Opportunity - AtlasEdge Data Centres, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://atlasedge.com/europes-playbook-britains-opportunity/>
43. Data centres at the intersection of sovereignty and innovation - Macfarlanes, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://www.macfarlanes.com/insights/102lty2/data-centres-at-the-intersection-of-sovereignty-and-innovation>
44. Achieving Digital Sovereignty in Defence cloud: a practical guide - techUK, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://www.techuk.org/resource/achieving-digital-sovereignty-in-defence-cloud-a-practical-guide.html>
45. The Rise of the UK Sovereign Cloud: Trust, Control, and the Return of Data Sovereignty, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://cyberfortgroup.com/the-rise-of-the-uk-sovereign-cloud-trust-control-and-the-return-of-data-sovereignty/>
46. Cybersecurity and digital identity in 2026: Designing trust for a world built on deception, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://www.thinkdigitalpartners.com/news/2026/01/21/cybersecurity-and-digital-identity-in-2026-designing-trust-for-a-world-built-on-deception/>
47. Identity security to become core cyber focus by 2026 - SecurityBrief UK, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://securitybrief.co.uk/story/identity-security-to-become-core-cyber-focus-by-2026>
48. The sovereignty shift: how UK and Irish SMEs can regain control of their data | TechRadar, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://www.techradar.com/pro/the-sovereignty-shift-how-uk-and-irish-smes-can-regain-control-of-their-data>
49. First fast-track cyber defenders now protecting UK from daily digital threats, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://www.gov.uk/government/news/first-fast-track-cyber-defenders-now-protecting-uk-from-daily-digital-threats>
50. Undersea Cables Under Attack, from Outside and Within - The ..., accessed January 28, 2026, <https://www.thecipherbrief.com/undersea-cable-attacks>
51. International Submarine Cable Resilience Summit 2026 - ITU, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://www.itu.int/digital-resilience/submarine-cables/events/about-porto-summit/>
52. Global submarine cable resilience under spotlight at international summit in Portugal - ITU, accessed January 28, 2026, <https://www.itu.int/en/mediacentre/Pages/MA-2026-01-26-Porto-Submarine-Cable-Resilience-Summit.aspx>